

Module 00

VS Code Optional

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
AUTHOR	Danny McMillan, Seller Sessions
YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

WHY -- Why This Matters

Before you can use AI tools, you need a workspace that's set up properly. VS Code is that workspace. GitHub Copilot is the tool that sets it up for you.

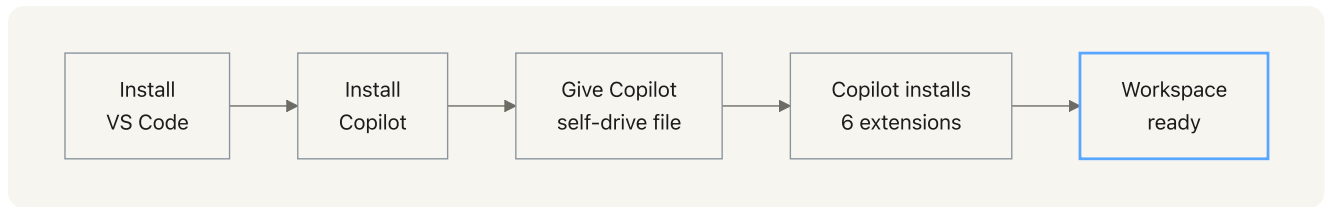
Important framing: Copilot is your **setup tool**. It installs extensions, configures your theme, and gets VS Code ready. From Module 1 onwards, **Claude Code CLI** is the main tool you'll use for building.

Think of it this way:

- **Copilot** = The person who sets up your desk on day one
- **Claude Code** = The colleague who works alongside you every day

WHAT -- What You'll Learn

How to use Copilot to configure a complete AI-powered workspace in under 10 minutes.



The 6 Extensions (hardcoded -- no more, no less)

#	EXTENSION ID	WHAT IT DOES
1	<code>github.copilot</code>	AI coding assistant (free tier: 100 tasks/month)
2	<code>github.copilot-chat</code>	Copilot chat panel inside VS Code
3	<code>anthropic.claude-code</code>	Claude Code -- the main AI tool from Module 1
4	<code>akamud.vscode-theme-onedark</code>	One Dark theme (easy on the eyes)
5	<code>cweijan.vscode-office</code>	View PDFs, markdown (WYSIWYG), and xlsx files
6	<code>yzhang.markdown-all-in-one</code>	Markdown shortcuts + table of contents

What You Need Before Starting

- VS Code installed (free from code.visualstudio.com)
- A GitHub account (free)
- Internet connection

HOW -- The Self-Drive Process

Same cycle as every module:

1. **You read** this README (done)
2. **You give Copilot the self-drive file** -- open `COPILLOT-SELF-DRIVE.md` , copy the contents, paste into Copilot Chat
3. **Copilot builds** -- it installs all 6 extensions, sets your theme, and verifies everything works

Making VS Code Feel Like Home

Once Copilot finishes the setup, these four tweaks make VS Code feel less like a code editor:

1. **Theme** -- One Dark is already installed. If you want something different, Command Palette (Cmd+Shift+P) -> "Color Theme"
2. **File icons** -- The Office extension gives you familiar icons for PDFs, spreadsheets, etc.
3. **Sidebar** -- Pin your project folder in the Explorer. Hide panels you don't use
4. **Font size** -- Cmd+Plus (Mac) / Ctrl+Plus (Windows) to zoom in until it feels comfortable

HOW -- The Self-Drive Process (continued)

When it's personalised, it stops feeling like software and starts feeling like home.

Quick Reference

WHAT	WHERE
Copilot Chat	Sidebar: Cmd+Shift+I (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+I (Windows)
Command Palette	Cmd+Shift+P (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+P (Windows)
Settings	Cmd+, (Mac) / Ctrl+, (Windows)
Agent Mode	Switch in Copilot chat dropdown menu

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
Copilot won't install	Update VS Code to latest version, check GitHub sign-in
Can't authenticate	Click "Sign in" when prompted, approve in browser, return to VS Code
Extensions not appearing	Make sure you're in Agent mode, restart VS Code

Also see [COPILLOT-CHEATSHEET.pdf](#) in this folder for a full troubleshooting guide.

WHAT IF -- What This Unlocks

Your workspace is now ready for the real work. From here:

- **Module 000** -- Install Claude Code CLI (the tool that does the heavy lifting)
- **Module 1** -- Create your `CLAUDE.md` file (custom instructions for Claude Code)
- **Module 2** -- Set up a Master Log (session continuity)
- **Module 3** -- Slash commands, skills, and Plan Mode (speed and control)
- **Module 4** -- MCPs (connect Claude to external services)
- **Module 5** -- AI agents (autonomous specialists)

Copilot stays available for quick tasks, but Claude Code is where the power is.

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